BLOOD DONOR EDUCATIONAL MATERIALS

YOU MUST READ THIS BEFORE YOU DONATE!

- **Your accurate and honest responses are critical to the safety of patients who receive blood transfusions.**
- Each question is necessary to fully evaluate the safety of your donation.
- As required by regulations, we are instructing you not to donate blood if you have a risk factor.
- If you don't understand a question, ask the blood center staff for assistance.
- YOUR RESPONSES ARE CONFIDENTIAL.

To determine if you are eligible to donate, we will:

- Ask about your health and medications you are taking or have taken.
- Ask if you have traveled to or lived in other countries.
- Ask about your risk for infections that can be transmitted by blood – especially HIV (which is the virus that causes AIDS), and viral hepatitis.
- Take your blood pressure, temperature, and pulse.
- Take a blood sample to be sure your blood count is acceptable before you donate.

If you are eligible to donate, we will:

- Clean your arm with an antiseptic (Tell us if you have any skin allergies).
- Use a sterile needle and tubing set to collect your blood.

We NEVER reuse a needle or tubing set.

WHAT HAPPENS AFTER YOUR DONATION

To protect patients, your blood is tested for hepatitis B and C, HIV, syphilis, and other infections. If your blood tests positive, it will not be given to a patient. You will be notified about any positive test result which may affect when you are eligible to donate in the future. There are times when your blood is not tested. If this occurs, you may not receive any notification. The blood center will not release your test results without your written permission unless required by law (e.g., to the Health Department).

DONOR ELIGIBILITY – SPECIFIC INFORMATION

Certain infectious diseases, such as HIV and hepatitis, can be spread through:

- Sexual contact
- Other activities that increase risk
- Blood transfusion

We will ask specific questions about sexual contact and other activities that may increase risk for these infections.

What do we mean by "sexual contact?"

The words "have sexual contact with" and "sex" are used in some of the questions we will ask you. These questions apply to all of the activities below, whether or not medications, condoms or other protection were used to prevent infection or pregnancy:

- Vaginal sex (contact between penis and vagina)
- Oral sex (mouth or tongue on someone's vagina, penis, or anus)
- Anal sex (contact between penis and anus)

A "new sexual partner" includes the following examples:

- Having sex with someone for the first time
  OR
- Having had sex with someone in a relationship that ended in the past, and having sex again with that person in the last 3 months.

HIV/Hepatitis risk factors

HIV and hepatitis are spread mainly by sexual contact with an infected person OR by sharing needles or syringes used by an infected person to inject drugs.

DO NOT DONATE if you:

- **Have EVER taken any medication to treat HIV infection.**
- **Are taking any medication to prevent HIV infection. These medications may be called: PrEP, PEP, TRUVADA, DESCOVY, APRETUDE or many other names.**

FDA-approved antiretroviral drugs are safe and effective in preventing sexual transmission of HIV. However, these antiretroviral drugs do not fully eliminate the virus from the body, and donated blood can potentially still transmit HIV infection to a transfusion recipient.

DO NOT STOP TAKING ANY PRESCRIBED MEDICATIONS IN ORDER TO DONATE BLOOD, INCLUDING PrEP and PEP MEDICATIONS.

DO NOT DONATE if you:

- Have **EVER** had a positive test for HIV infection.
- **In the past 3 months:**
  - Have had sexual contact with a new partner **and** have had anal sex.
  - Have had sexual contact with more than one partner **and** have had anal sex.
  - Have had sexual contact with anyone who has ever had a positive test for HIV infection.
  - Have received money, drugs, or other payment for sex.
  - Have used needles to inject drugs, steroids, or anything not prescribed by your doctor.
  - Have had sexual contact with anyone who has received money, drugs, or other payment for sex, **or** used needles to inject drugs, steroids, or anything not prescribed by their doctor.
  - Have had syphilis or gonorrhea or been treated for syphilis or gonorrhea.
- **In the past 12 months:**
  - Have been in juvenile detention, lockup, jail or prison for 72 hours or more consecutively.
- Have **EVER** had Ebola virus infection or disease.

DO NOT DONATE if you have these symptoms which can be present before you test positive for HIV:

- Fever
- Enlarged lymph glands
- Sore throat
- Rash

Your blood can transmit infections, including HIV, even if you feel well and all your tests are normal. Even the best tests cannot detect the virus for a period of time after you are infected.

DO NOT DONATE:

- If you think you may be at risk for HIV or other infections.
- If your purpose for donating is to obtain test results for HIV or other infections. Ask us where you can be tested for HIV and other infections.
- If your donation might harm the patient who receives your blood.

THANK YOU FOR DONATING BLOOD TODAY!

Blood Assurance – 705 E 4th St. – Chattanooga, TN 37403
800-962-0628
www.bloodassurance.org

ATTENTION DONORS: PLEASE READ BEFORE DONATING BLOOD

What happens during the donation process?

Our donor care specialists will:

- Ask you for identification
- Measure your blood pressure, pulse and temperature and take a sample of blood from your finger to make sure it is safe for you to donate
- Ask questions in a confidential setting about your health, travel, and sexual history
- Insert a needle in your arm to collect blood

What are the different methods of donating blood?

You may give whole blood or, using a method called apheresis, you may give blood components including platelets, plasma, and single or double red cells. In whole blood donation, the blood is directly drawn into a bag. In apheresis, the blood is drawn into a machine that separates blood into components. Some portions of the blood are retained by the machine and the rest is returned to you. The blood is mixed with anticoagulant solution to prevent clotting. Some of the anticoagulant solution and/or some salt solution are returned to you with the blood.

What are the possible complications of whole blood and apheresis donation?

Blood donation is generally a safe experience. Few people experience side effects related to donation. The most common side effects include pain, bruising, redness or infection at the donation site. Donors may also experience lightheadedness, nausea, vomiting, dizziness, hyperventilation and fainting. Fainting can cause a fall in which the donor becomes injured. Other rare and potentially serious complications of donation include seizures, nerve, muscle or blood vessel damage, shock, air embolism, compartment syndrome (compression of nerves, blood vessels and muscle inside an enclosed space), blood clotting, severe allergic reaction, red cell destruction, irregular heartbeat, and death. Apheresis donors may experience tingling, low calcium and muscle twitching or spasms related to the anticoagulant solution. Regular apheresis donors may experience a reduction in lymphocyte count (a type of white cell). The long-term effects of this are unknown. Materials containing latex may be used during the donation process, so donors with this allergy should let Blood Assurance staff know in order to avoid possible severe reaction.

How can I replace the iron that I donated?

Blood donation may remove most of the body's iron stores in female donors of childbearing age and young or frequent donors of either sex. The impact of iron loss on health varies. Symptoms may include fatigue, decreased exercise capacity and pica (a craving to chew things such as ice or chalk). Because people are limited in how much iron they absorb daily (e.g. 2-4 mg/day), the goal is to replace the 200-250 mg of iron in donated blood over 1-3 months. A single large dose of iron or a single iron rich meal will not replace the iron lost in blood donation. Your healthcare provider or pharmacist may assist you in deciding what dose, type and duration of iron supplement to choose because iron supplementation is not right for everyone. A typical multivitamin with 18 mg of iron has been shown to boost iron stores when taken for 60 days following donation. Consuming citrus juice or foods rich in vitamin C along with an iron supplement or iron rich foods can help your body absorb the iron more effectively. Iron rich foods include meat, eggs, dried beans, peas, iron-fortified cereals, dark green leafy vegetables, dried fruits, nuts and seeds.

What happens to my blood and donor information following donation?

Your donated blood is used for transfusion to patients. Any blood or blood samples remaining after patient needs are met may be used for research or commercial use in order to learn more about blood transfusion, develop new treatments and lab tests, and to advance science and patient care in general. Donor information may also be used for scientific research. Researchers are not provided with any donor information that would allow them to identify a particular donor. Blood and donor information may be kept indefinitely. Donor participation is voluntary and without financial benefit to you. You may change your mind at any time without affecting your relationship with Blood Assurance. If you experience a medical issue following your donation or have further questions, then please call our main line at 1-800-962-0628.

THANK YOU FOR DONATING BLOOD TODAY

Blood Assurance – 705 E 4th St. – Chattanooga, TN 37403 – 800.962.0628 – www.bloodassurance.org